

COMMON LADDER · VISUAL BRAND SYSTEM

Every rung, together.

The complete visual identity for commonladder.org — logo, color, type, voice, and how to apply the brand across web, print, social, and beyond.



Version
1.0

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Maintainer
Common Ladder team

01 — THE BRAND IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Common Ladder is a civic resource platform.

It connects people experiencing homelessness, the case managers and nonprofits who serve them, government agencies, and donors. The brand reads as civic, warm, plain-language, and dignified — not corporate, not bureaucratic, not charity-coded. Every visual choice in this guide is in service of that posture.

Three meanings in the name. *Ladder* — upward movement, step by step. *Common* — shared ownership, the civic commons. *Together* — stability and housing as collective achievement, not individual charity.

Lead tagline: "*Every rung, together.*"

02 — LOGO

The lockup

The logo pairs a three-hexagon rising mark with a lowercase two-color wordmark. The hexagons step from Ladder Blue through Resource Sage to Rung Amber — left-to-right, low-to-high — visualizing collective progress through the civic commons. The wordmark sets *common* in Ladder Blue and *ladder* in Rung Amber, with no space between, so the two ideas read as one word.



Primary lockup

Use on Commons White, pure white, or very light backgrounds. This is the default everywhere.



Reverse lockup

Use on Ladder Blue, deep neutrals, or dark photography. The bottom hexagon flips to white; "common" flips to white; "ladder" stays amber so brand recognition carries.



Mark only

For favicons, social avatars, app icons, watermarks. Use when the full wordmark would be illegible or visually noisy.



Mark only, reverse

Same as above on dark surfaces. Bottom hex switches to white.

Clear space

Always leave a clear margin around the logo equal to the height of one hexagon. Don't crowd it with type, photography, or other graphic elements within that zone.



The amber dashed outline shows the minimum clear space — equal to one hexagon height (≈ 48 px in the master file).

Minimum sizes

The wordmark must remain legible. Don't render the full lockup below 120 px wide on screen or 1 inch (25 mm) wide in print. Below that, switch to the mark-only icon.



320 PX — FULL LOCKUP



180 PX — MINIMUM RECOMMENDED



64 PX — MARK ONLY



32 PX — FAVICON FLOOR

03 — LOGO DO'S & DON'TS

Use the logo with confidence.

The logo is the single hardest-working visual asset Common Ladder owns. Protect its proportions, its colors, and its breathing room.

DO



Primary lockup on Commons White or pure white.

DO



Reverse lockup on Ladder Blue or other dark fields.

DON'T



Don't place on washed-out or mid-tone backgrounds where the blue collapses.

DON'T



Don't lay the logo over busy patterns or photography that fights with the mark.

DON'T



Don't rotate, tilt, or "make it dynamic." The lockup is horizontal.

DON'T



Don't stretch, squish, or otherwise distort the proportions.

DON'T



Don't recolor the mark or wordmark to off-brand colors. The palette is the brand.

DON'T



Don't add a space between "common" and "ladder." They are one word.

04 — COLOR

A small, intentional palette.

Two colors carry the brand. A third supports. A neutral grounds it. Use this palette confidently and don't introduce ad-hoc accent colors — restraint is part of the brand's posture.



Ladder Blue

HEX #1C3D6E

RGB 28 / 61 / 110

CMYK 91 / 75 / 22 / 5

Primary · headings · nav · logo anchor



Rung Amber

HEX #E8911A

RGB 232 / 145 / 26

CMYK 5 / 47 / 100 / 0

Action · CTAs · highlights · upward moments

Resource Sage

HEX #4A9E82

RGB 74 / 158 / 130

CMYK 71 / 13 / 56 / 0

Category tags · health · success states

Commons White

HEX #F8F7F4

RGB 248 / 247 / 244

CMYK 2 / 2 / 4 / 0

Background · warm off-white (not clinical)

Body Ink

HEX #1A1F2B

RGB 26 / 31 / 43

CMYK 87 / 78 / 60 / 86

Body copy on light backgrounds

Amber Dark

HEX #b36a00

RGB 179 / 106 / 0

CMYK 21 / 64 / 100 / 9

WCAG-safe amber for text on white

Important — contrast rule: Rung Amber and Resource Sage both fail WCAG AA contrast against white. Use them only as button fills, badge backgrounds, or icon accents — **never as body text on white**. When you need an amber for text on a light background, switch to **#b36a00** (Amber Dark) — the approved accessible fallback.

Two typefaces. Many voices.

Manrope for display (headlines, the wordmark, key UI). Inter for body (paragraphs, labels, lists). Both are open-source, free for commercial use, and load cleanly from Google Fonts. No third typeface — restraint again.

H1 / DISPLAY — MANROPE 800

Every rung, together.

```
font-family: Manrope · font-weight: 800 · font-size: clamp(2rem, 5vw, 3rem) · letter-spacing: -0.02em
```

H2 / SECTION — MANROPE 700

Find the resources you qualify for.

```
font-family: Manrope · font-weight: 700 · font-size: clamp(1.5rem, 3vw, 2.1rem) · letter-spacing: -0.01em
```

H3 / SUBSECTION — MANROPE 700

Your most important action right now

```
font-family: Manrope · font-weight: 700 · font-size: 1.25rem
```

H4 / CARD TITLE — MANROPE 600

Stay-Housed Navigator (Maricopa)

```
font-family: Manrope · font-weight: 600 · font-size: 1.05rem
```

BODY — INTER 400 — THE DEFAULT TEXT STYLE FOR EVERY PAGE

Common Ladder is a civic resource platform. We help people experiencing homelessness, the case managers and nonprofits who serve them, government agencies, and donors find each other faster. No accounts. No data sold. Everything plainly explained.

font-family: Inter · font-weight: 400 · font-size: 1rem · line-height: 1.6

SMALL / CAPTION — INTER 400

Verified 2026-05-15 · Sources: 211 AZ, HUD HDX

font-family: Inter · font-weight: 400 · font-size: 0.85rem · color: var(--gray)

06 — VOICE & TONE

Civic, warm, plain-language.

Common Ladder serves multiple audiences in one breath — someone seeking help tonight, a case manager mid-shift, a city director, a donor reviewing impact. The voice has to land for all of them. Plain words. No jargon. No charity-savior framing. No bureaucratic stiffness. Treat readers as adults navigating a hard system, because they are.

DO

"Call 211 — they know which shelters have beds tonight. If one's full, ask them to make a warm referral to the next one so you skip the line."

— concrete, useful, treats the reader as capable.

DON'T

"Individuals experiencing housing insecurity should leverage available coordinated-entry resources to navigate the continuum of care."

— bureaucratic, distant, hides the help inside jargon.

DO

"You don't have to start over at every door. Always ask: *can you call ahead for me?*"

— *actionable, conversational, gives a sentence to actually say.*

DON'T

"Empower yourself by advocating for warm hand-offs across service providers."

— *preachy, abstract, "empower" doing all the work and saying nothing.*

DO

"Built in Phoenix · Free to use, always."

— *specific, honest, no promises beyond what we can keep.*

DON'T

"Empowering communities nationwide through innovative solutions."

— *could be any nonprofit anywhere doing anything.*

07 — SAMPLE APPLICATIONS

The brand in the wild.

How the system lands across the surfaces Common Ladder actually ships to: web header, business card, social post, printed handout. Each example uses only the assets on this page.



commonladder

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Every resource. **Every next step.**

Find shelters, food, healthcare, and housing programs near you — updated daily, in plain language, no account required.



commonladder

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Every rung, together.



Lose your ID? Here's the order to recover it — without an address.

[commonladder.org](#)



A Phoenix-specific plan for the 72 hours between intake and a bed.

[commonladder.org](#)



Stay-Housed Navigator — for households at risk of eviction

If your client has received a 5-day or pay-or-quit notice, route them here *today*. The navigator screens for the seven Maricopa rent & utility programs and outputs an ordered call list with the right intake hours.

- Wildfire — emergency rent assistance, 7-day turnaround
- St. Vincent de Paul — back-rent + utility, no income cap
- A New Leaf — rapid-rehousing intake (HUD-funded)
- Maricopa County HSD — for families with children under 18
- Tempe CAA — Tempe-only residents, fastest decision (48h)

commonladder.org/static-tools/stay-housed-maricopa.html **Every rung, together.**

08 — ASSETS & DOWNLOADS

Where to find the source files.

All brand assets are vector SVG files maintained in the public repo. Always pull from there — never re-create the logo by hand or export it from a screenshot.

- [logo-primary.svg](#) — full lockup for light backgrounds
- [logo-reverse.svg](#) — full lockup for dark backgrounds (Ladder Blue plate baked in)
- [icon-mark.svg](#) — mark only, for favicons / avatars / app icons
- [icon-mark-reverse.svg](#) — mark only on dark plate
- [favicon.svg](#) — the live site favicon

For raster exports (PNG, JPG) at specific sizes for print or social, open any SVG in a vector tool (Figma, Illustrator, Inkscape) and export at the size you need. The vector source ensures crisp output at every scale. To download a PDF of this guide, use your browser's ⌘ P / Ctrl P print dialog and choose "Save as PDF."

09 — CHANGELOG

Version history.

- **v1.0 · 2026-05-31** — Initial visual brand system: civic-grid logo (3 rising hexagons + lowercase two-color wordmark), primary + reverse lockups, mark-only variants, full color palette with WCAG-safe Amber Dark fallback, Manrope display + Inter body type stack, voice principles, do's & don'ts, sample applications across web / print / social.